

The Noble Avalokiteśvara's One Hundred and Eight Names, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra

Ārya-Avalokiteśvara-aṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita · Toh 634 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱ་རས་གཟགིས་དབང་ཡུལ་ག་མཚན་བརྒྱ་མརྒྱ་པ་གཟུངས་སྐུས་དང་བཅས་པ།

Toh 634 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Avalokiteśvara-aṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita and in Tibetan as "Phags pa spyan ras gzigs dbang phyug gi mtshan brgya rtsa brgyad pa gzungs sngags dang bcas pa," rendered in English as "The Noble Avalokiteśvara's One Hundred and Eight Names, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra." The text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist literature, presenting a sacred enumeration of one hundred and eight names of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara — the embodiment of compassion — accompanied by dhāraṇī syllables and mantras intended for recitation and ritual use. It opens with homage to Avalokiteśvara and depicts the Tathāgatas of the ten directions consecrating him, situating the names and dhāraṇī within a celestial ceremonial context. As part of the Kangyur, it falls among those canonical scriptures translated from Indian sources that were preserved and transmitted in the Tibetan Buddhist tradition.

In the language of India: Ārya-Avalokiteśvara-aṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Avalokiteśvara's One Hundred and Eight Names, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra.

Homage to the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara.

Namas sarva-buddha-bodhisattvānāṃ. Samanta-amogha. Apratihata. Śāsanānāṃ. Nama āryāvalokiteśvarāya. Mahābodhisattvāya. Vajrasattvāya. Vajravipulāya. Padmasaṃbhavāya. Padmayonye. Tadyathā: Oṃ hrīḥ karaśrīkara, prabhākara, vajrasattva, vajrasaṃbhava, padmasaṃbhava, padmasāgara, padmagocara, varada mahākāruṇika, kāruṇasaṃbhava, hūṃ hūṃ, dhara dhara, dara dara, vara vara, mahākāruṇika mahāśuddhasattva svāhā.

Then all the Tathāgatas of the ten directions extended their right hands and anointed the crown of the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara's head, and declared: "O great heap of precious qualities, it is excellent, excellent that you have expounded this dhāraṇī mantra and thereby taught sentient beings the Dharma from which buddhahood arises. This alone, merely by being heard,

purifies sentient beings most completely. Whoever listens to it, bears it in mind, reads it, and masters it fully will obtain all excellent qualities in their perfection and will attain the supreme state of purity."

Then the great sovereign lord of the gods (Indra, king of the devas), pervading incalculable hundreds of thousands of leagues and filling the entirety of the three worlds, together with his retinue — and all the bodhisattvas assembled in the vajra maṇḍala — bowed their heads and praised the noble Avalokiteśvara with the one hundred and eight names called "The Sovereign of the Earth, the Hero Who Delights in Play."

Lord of the earth, dwelling within the vajra maṇḍala,
sovereign of the great qualities of all three realms without remainder,
possessor of a maṇḍala that is pure, stainless, and luminous,
vast maṇḍala suffused with compassion.

Supremely joyful, supremely glad, supremely a teacher,
of excellent fortune, supreme in the peace of liberation,
utterly pure, sovereign of great qualities,
a crown of flowers renowned as pure in many ways.

The single eye of the pure three realms, supremely exalted,
bestowing excellence, beautifying the wealth of all beings,
arising through immeasurable aeons even beyond the immeasurable,
performing what is timely and what captures the mind, acting with clarity.

Crowned with a jewel-crest, born of the vajra,
sole hero of the three realms, with lotus eyes,
ocean of learning, braver than all sentient beings,
the supreme one who liberates all wandering beings completely.

Adorned at the throat with garlands, holding a pure lotus,
the sovereign with a crown crest in which the Sugata (the well-gone Buddha) abides,
a form beautifully ornamented with excellent conduct and qualities,
bearing weapons of the great and violent wind of fear.

The cause of virtue, the cause of striving for what is sacred,
the cause of the supreme great bliss of resources enjoyed in the proper manner,
the sole cause of the conduct-domain of the supreme maṇḍala,
the sole protection that liberates the three realms.

The ornament of the supreme maṇḍala, free of wrongdoing,
a support endowed with a radiance of golden light,
through equality becoming equal with the unequal and peerless,
having attained the grounds, adorned with a garland of spreading rays of light.

The greatness of the great, unobstructed,
having cleared away all former darkness, free of affliction,
the domain of virtuous purity, utterly pure,
the maṇḍala vast and pure in the proper manner.

Sovereign of the three realms, born of the lotus,
lord of the blissful and vast three realms,
the unwavering sovereign, skilled in yoga,
the great Tathāgata, supremely exalted and vast.

Bearing a vajra ornament set with a jeweled adornment,
adorned with lotuses, born of the great mountain.

Sole vessel of virtue and great qualities,
sovereign who guides beings to bliss and great enjoyment,
possessed of a vast ocean of aspiration prayers,
liberating beings who fall into the depths of existence.

Beholding all things equal to the earth,
the light of the auspicious aeon of a thousand kalpas,
bearing the maṇḍala adorned with the supreme vajra,
having as a maṇḍala the distinct enumeration of qualities.

Possessed of the heroic power of virtuous defining marks,
with suchness, the taste of the Dharma, as the domain of activity,
bearing the maṇḍala of the crown jewel and red bindus,
sovereign over the hundred Great Gods (Śiva) and lord of the thirty-three,
bowed to by gods and asuras who have been brought under sway,
possessed of a hundredfold diligence and a thousandfold power,
bearing a hundredfold merit and a hundred weapons,
born from the very lotus of the hundredfold lotus.

Resplendent at the center of a hundred maṇḍalas,
the Teacher who possesses a hundred Dharmas and reveals a thousand excellences,
praised in full by many hundreds of thousands of buddhas,
skilled through many immeasurable kalpas.

Heroic in body among many pure maṇḍalas,
the Teacher possessed of might that transcends the world,
abiding at the center of a vast and stainless maṇḍala,
scattering flowers in a blaze of supreme joy,

radiant in robes of white silk,
from the maṇḍala of the mind adorned by compassion,
golden in every detail, endless and inexhaustible,
the hero endowed with a hundred rays of sunlight.

The maṇḍala of jewels, luminous as the moon,
bearing the supreme lotus opened by the sun,
renowned as the god who holds flowers as weapons,
the third-knotted forelock, son of Brahmā, lord of all beings.

Of noble lineage, supreme, born within the great family,
illuminating one's own lineage, bearing the great empowered maṇḍala,
of the lineage of the excellent lotus, marked with a bindu,
with beautiful eyes, become the support of virtuous gods.

Lord who holds the power of many secret mantras,
sovereign lord assembled before the great gathering,
the maṇḍala made beautiful by three pure eyes,
taming the hostile with the voice of the kalavinka bird.

Bearing arrow and bow, great powerful weapons,
the god of strength who tames through power and diligence,
adorned well with varied ornaments,
praised by the many Victors and holders of the vidyā mantras,
greatly praised by those who bring joy in the feasts of offering,
liberating completely from the terrors of the sea-monster's (makara's) gripping throne,
possessing many forms and granting supreme bliss,
having as a maṇḍala the distinctions of the realm of the gods.

Even the peerless ones cannot match this peerless power and might,
the one who proceeds in ease, endowed with great supreme qualities and rays of light,
Avalokiteśvara, skilled within the world,
bearing the maṇḍala at the center of the maṇḍala of the earth's ground.

Rays of light, many thousands, without exhaustion,
dispelling all the dust of afflictions,
free of extremes, the all-seeing one,
with the domain of activity of perfect peace, supremely exalted.

In meaning and in method, the hero singular among sentient beings,
the sun who holds fast to the excellent vehicle,
having obtained faith in discipline, giving, and ethical conduct,
crushing without remainder all stains of beings.

The Teacher who displays excellent intelligence and supreme joy,
arrayed in blissful garments, light and varied,
the Blessed One who renders arising and existence free of fear,
the giver who always bestows the supreme good.

The intelligence that has attained the liberation spoken of by the Victor,
vast in bliss and enjoyment, stainless,
the maṇḍala of the face vast and immaculate,
supreme among the hands of humans, those without craving, and Śakra
(Indra, lord of the gods).

Sovereign who beholds many worlds,
great in strength, lineage, and might,
equal to the buddhas, equal to the supreme precious Dharma,
equal to the Saṅgha, difficult to match in dispassion and mastery.

The three supreme distinctions equal to the greatest jewel,
the all-pervading lord who has swept away the triple dust of afflictions.

I bow to you, supreme Vajrasattva (Skt. vajrasattva).
Bearing the immaculate lotus in the midst of your hands,
with the jeweled crown adorning your head, you with the crest-mark on your
brow,
holding the form of the crowned one — I bow to you, whose crown is sealed
with Amitābha.

Then the Blessed One, the Self-Arisen, Dispeller of Darkness,
steady as the roll of a great drum, declared:

"This praise-song to the supreme great Vajra, the hymn
of the one hundred and eight names, is excellent and clears away all faults.

If there is anyone who always desires the highest good
and praises the lord Avalokiteśvara,

without long delay they will attain
the supreme great enjoyment of qualities and the Dharma.

Whatever person constantly praises him thus,
the noble lord Avalokiteśvara will grant them blessings.
Sins will no longer arise in them,
and whatever they desire they will easily obtain.
They will not be stained by the impurity of wrongdoing,
and they will go on, keeping their sight on the straight and good path.
The lotus-born, the sole refuge worthy of the three realms of existence —
they will likewise come to practice the supreme Dharma.

So it is that whoever seeks the accomplishment of these distinctive names,
whoever always desires happiness,
should ceaselessly praise Avalokiteśvara,
the lord of all beings, the master of every living creature,
the one arisen from the lotus."

This completes the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Blessed One, the
sublime teacher, the lord noble Avalokiteśvara, together with the dhāraṇī
mantra.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit dhāraṇī and mantra syllables are rendered phonetically as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration without emendation, as is standard practice for liturgical texts of this kind. Some Sanskrit forms in the mantra body are irregular or contracted and do not require scholarly correction in a devotional rendering.

The epithet "Sovereign of the Earth, the Hero Who Delights in Play" renders the Tibetan sa'i dbang phyug dpa' bo rnam par rtse ba, a name-title given to the sequence of one hundred and eight names that follows; it functions as the title of the stotra embedded within the dhāraṇī text.

The phrase rendered "the great sovereign lord of the gods" translates lha'i dbang po dbang phyug chen po, a compound epithet for Indra that also carries the sense of Maheśvara (Śiva) in some contexts, but here the syntax and context indicate Indra, the king of the gods (Śakra), rather than Śiva.

- The phrase rendered "sea-monster's gripping throne" renders "chu srin 'dzin khri," which literally means "makara-held throne" or "throne held by makaras." This is a standard iconographic reference to a throne supported by makara figures; the translation preserves the sense while clarifying the reference for listeners.

The "third-knotted forelock" and "son of Brahmā" are epithets whose referent shifts between a solar or brahmanical divine figure and the main subject of the hymn throughout this passage; the text appears to be a litany of epithets addressed to Avalokiteśvara, drawing on both

Buddhist and Brahmanical imagery in a syncretic manner typical of dhāraṇī-literature.

The "triple dust of afflictions" at the close renders "nyon mongs rnam gsum rdul," the three afflictions conventionally being attachment, aversion, and delusion.

- The phrase rendered "Self-Arisen, Dispeller of Darkness" translates Tibetan epithets of the Blessed One used here in a salutation context; "Self-Arisen" (rang byung) and "Dispeller of Darkness" (mun sel ba) are standard epithets applied to the Buddha. The line on Vajrasattva at the opening is a closing homage verse to Vajrasattva appearing before the colophon, a common liturgical feature in dhāraṇī texts of this type.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.